

Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions Module (VARCM)

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

Parent Standard: Validation Criteria Standard (VCRS)

Operational Layer: Validation Criteria Governance Layer

Category: AI & Interpretation

Subcategory: Validation Governance

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Governed Space: Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions

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· ORA™ · AGA™ · AIG® · CLIA® · MGIA™ · ASGA™ · RIS™

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Governed Space

Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions

Canonical Definition

Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions Module (VARCM) defines

the governance framework for establishing, distinguishing, structuring, documenting, maintaining, and controlling the conditions under which individual Validation Criteria may be considered satisfied, not satisfied, conditionally satisfied, or not determinable.

It establishes the evaluation logic necessary to translate criterion-level observations and threshold relationships into governed criterion outcomes without prematurely producing the overall Validation Determination.

Operational Role

VARCM governs the acceptance-and-rejection condition layer of Validation Criteria governance.

Its role is to establish **what must occur for an individual Validation Criterion to receive a defined evaluation outcome.**

The module operates after Validation Requirements, Validation

Criteria, and applicable Validation Thresholds have been sufficiently established.

The progression becomes: **Validation Requirement** → **Validation Criterion** → **Validation Threshold** → **Acceptance & Rejection Conditions**

VARCM does not determine whether the complete Validation Object is valid.

It defines the criterion-level outcome conditions required for later validation determination.

Module Operational Space

VARCM governs:

- criterion acceptance conditions,
 - criterion rejection conditions,
 - conditional satisfaction,
 - non-determinability,
 - criterion outcome logic,
 - mandatory conditions,
 - exclusionary conditions,
 - composite-condition logic,
 - conditional activation,
 - tolerance interpretation,
 - threshold relationship,
 - uncertainty treatment,
 - incomplete evaluation conditions,
 - conflicting outcome conditions,
 - acceptance and rejection stability,
 - condition change,
 - versioning,
 - and outcome-condition traceability.
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Module Function

VARCM applies wherever a Validation Criterion requires explicit logic for interpreting subsequent evaluation results.

Its function is to prevent:

- undefined acceptance logic,
 - undefined rejection logic,
 - threshold crossing being automatically equated with complete validity,
 - missing evidence being treated as failure,
 - unresolved uncertainty being treated as success,
 - incomplete evaluation being represented as acceptance,
 - materially different criterion outcomes being collapsed into binary pass/fail states,
 - acceptance conditions being changed after results are observed,
 - rejection conditions being selectively ignored,
 - and criterion outcomes being determined through undocumented judgment.
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Criterion Outcome Principle

A Validation Criterion requires more than a definition and threshold.

It requires explicit conditions governing how evaluation results will be interpreted.

VARCM therefore distinguishes at minimum between:

Satisfied

The available governed evaluation supports satisfaction of the criterion under the applicable conditions.

Not Satisfied

The governed evaluation demonstrates that the criterion's required condition has not been satisfied.

Conditionally Satisfied

The criterion is satisfied only under explicitly governed conditions, limitations, assumptions, or applicability boundaries.

Not Determinable

Available validation activity does not provide sufficient basis to determine whether the criterion is satisfied or not satisfied.

These outcomes are methodologically different.

They must not be silently treated as equivalent.

Acceptance Conditions

Acceptance conditions define what must be demonstrated before a Validation Criterion may be classified as satisfied.

Acceptance may depend upon:

- satisfaction of an applicable threshold,
- required evidence conditions,
- required confidence,
- absence of exclusionary conditions,
- satisfaction of subordinate criteria,
- required operating conditions,
- applicable contextual conditions,
- defined tolerances,
- or another pre-established validation condition.

Acceptance must be based on the conditions established before the relevant result is interpreted.

Rejection Conditions

Rejection conditions define circumstances under which a Validation Criterion cannot be considered satisfied.

These may include:

- failure to reach a minimum threshold,
- exceeding a maximum threshold,
- entering a prohibited range,
- occurrence of an exclusionary condition,
- violation of a mandatory requirement,
- failure of a required subordinate criterion,
- or another explicitly established rejection condition.

Rejection must remain distinguishable from inability to determine an outcome.

Failure Versus Non-Determinability

VARCM establishes a critical VALIDOS® distinction:

Evidence of failure ≠ absence of evidence of satisfaction.

For example, if required evidence cannot be obtained, this may prevent criterion acceptance.

However, it does not necessarily demonstrate criterion rejection.

Likewise:

Not proven satisfied ≠ proven not satisfied.

This distinction prevents incomplete validation from generating false negative conclusions.

Acceptance Versus Absence of Failure

The inverse distinction is equally important:

No observed failure ≠ demonstrated satisfaction.

A criterion cannot be accepted merely because validation activity did not detect a problem.

Acceptance requires the governed conditions for satisfaction to have been affirmatively met.

This protects validation against false positive conclusions created

by insufficient examination.

Conditional Satisfaction

Some criteria may be satisfied only under defined conditions.

Conditional satisfaction may depend upon:

- a restricted use case,
- a particular environment,
- a specific population,
- a defined system configuration,
- continued availability of a dependency,
- a temporary mitigation,
- a limited operating period,
- or another governed condition.

The condition must remain attached to the criterion outcome.

A **Conditionally Satisfied** criterion must not later be represented simply as **Satisfied** if the governing condition remains material.

Exclusionary Conditions

Some conditions may prevent criterion acceptance regardless of other favorable results.

For example, an otherwise strong performance result may not satisfy a criterion if a mandatory safety condition is violated.

VARCM permits explicit **Exclusionary Conditions** to be established where methodologically justified.

Exclusionary conditions must be defined before outcome interpretation and remain traceable to their governing requirement.

Composite Acceptance Logic

A Composite Validation Criterion may depend upon multiple subordinate criteria or conditions.

VARCM requires the relationship between those elements to be explicit.

Possible structures may include:

ALL conditions required

ANY defined condition sufficient

Minimum number of conditions required

Weighted combination

Mandatory core + conditional supporting conditions or another governed logic.

Aggregation must not conceal material subordinate failures, unresolved states, or exclusions.

Threshold Relationship

Threshold satisfaction may contribute to criterion acceptance but does not automatically define the complete acceptance condition.

For example:

Observed Result $\geq$ Validation Threshold

may be necessary but insufficient where the criterion also requires:

- minimum confidence,
- defined environmental conditions,
- evidence completeness,
- absence of exclusionary conditions,
- or satisfaction of another dependency.

VARCM therefore governs the transition:

Threshold Relationship → Criterion Outcome Logic

Uncertainty Treatment

Where uncertainty materially affects interpretation, acceptance and rejection conditions should define how that uncertainty is treated.

Possible conditions may include:

- uncertainty entirely within an acceptable boundary,
- uncertainty overlapping a threshold,
- uncertainty exceeding a permitted tolerance,
- or uncertainty preventing reliable determination.

VARCM prevents uncertainty from being silently ignored merely because a central estimate satisfies a threshold.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Identify Criterion Outcome Requirements

Determine which conditions must govern interpretation of the Validation Criterion.

2. Establish Acceptance Conditions

Define what must be demonstrated for the criterion to be classified as satisfied.

3. Establish Rejection Conditions

Define what must be demonstrated for the criterion to be classified as not satisfied.

4. Establish Conditional and Non-Determinable States

Determine when the criterion may be:

- conditionally satisfied,
- unresolved,
- incomplete,
- or not determinable.

5. Establish Composite or Exclusionary Logic

Where applicable, define dependencies, aggregation rules, mandatory conditions, and exclusionary conditions.

6. Preserve Condition Traceability

Maintain:

- associated Validation Criterion,
- applicable Validation Threshold,
- acceptance conditions,
- rejection conditions,
- conditional-satisfaction conditions,
- non-determinability conditions,
- exclusionary conditions,
- composite logic,
- uncertainty rules,
- version,
- changes,
- and sufficient lifecycle traceability.

Condition Stability

Acceptance and rejection conditions must remain sufficiently stable during validation.

They must not be modified simply because:

- an observed result would otherwise fail,
- stakeholders prefer acceptance,
- validation has become expensive,
- operational deployment is delayed,
- or a preferred conclusion has already been communicated.

Changing outcome logic after results are known may fundamentally alter the legitimacy of the validation process.

Condition Change Governance

Material changes may nevertheless become necessary because of:

- revised Validation Requirements,
- revised Validation Criteria,
- changed thresholds,
- new scientific evidence,
- regulatory changes,
- corrected methodological errors,
- changed Validation Purpose,
- changed Validation Scope,
- or newly identified operational conditions.

Material changes must be:

- justified,
 - documented,
 - versioned,
 - propagated to affected validation activities,
 - and assessed for impact upon previous criterion outcomes.
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Outcome Condition Versioning

Every criterion outcome should remain connected to the version of acceptance and rejection conditions under which it was produced.

This preserves the ability to answer:

Under which outcome logic was this criterion classified?

A later modification of acceptance logic must not silently rewrite the methodological basis of historical validation results.

Criterion Outcome Versus Validation Determination

VARCM establishes criterion-level interpretation.

It does not aggregate all criterion outcomes into the final validation conclusion.

Therefore:

Criterion Satisfied ≠ Validation Object Validated

and:

Criterion Not Satisfied ≠ Validation Object Automatically Invalid

The significance of individual criterion outcomes depends upon:

- criterion classification,
- hierarchy,
- mandatory status,
- dependencies,
- Validation Purpose,
- and later Validation Determination governance.

This separation prevents premature validity conclusions.

Use Case 1 — AI Performance Criterion

Scenario

An AI model must satisfy a predefined performance threshold before deployment.

The measured result exceeds the threshold, but uncertainty around the result overlaps the minimum permitted boundary.

Application

VARCM applies the predefined acceptance logic, including the uncertainty condition.

Threshold satisfaction alone does not automatically establish criterion acceptance.

Result

The criterion may remain **Not Determinable** or **Conditionally Satisfied** until the required confidence condition is established.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous System Safety Criterion

Scenario

An autonomous system satisfies multiple performance requirements but violates a mandatory safety condition classified as exclusionary.

Application

VARCM applies the pre-established exclusionary logic.

Favorable results against other conditions cannot override the mandatory rejection condition.

Result

The affected criterion is classified according to the governed rejection logic without allowing aggregation to conceal the material safety failure.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions Module establishes the canonical governance framework for translating Validation Criteria and applicable thresholds into explicit criterion-level outcome conditions. By governing satisfaction, non-satisfaction, conditional satisfaction, non-determinability, exclusionary conditions, composite logic, uncertainty, stability, change, versioning, and traceability, VARCM ensures that validation outcomes are not reduced to arbitrary pass/fail judgments and that every criterion result remains connected to the evaluation logic under which it was legitimately established.

Parent Resources

→ [VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Internal Module Flow

→ [Previous module: Validation Threshold Calibration Module \(VTCM\)](#)

→ [Next module: Validation Criteria Coherence Module \(VCCM\)](#)

Related Documents

→ [Validation Criteria Standard](#)

→ [About Validation Criteria Standard](#)

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